

drawer. Simply check all the apps you want to place in the folder and once you've selected all the apps, click on the small folder icon on the top-right corner of the screen. A new folder with all the apps you've selected will be created. To rename your newly-created folder, simply tap the folder name and enter a new one.



REARRANGE SEARCH RESULTS

Microsoft Launcher has a useful universal search bar that lets you search for apps, people, messages, settings, and more within your smartphone. The launcher also includes the feature of letting you reorder these search results according to your preference. So, if you want apps to appear first in the search list, you can tell the launcher to do so. To reorder search results, go to Microsoft Launcher settings and then head over to 'Search'. Tap on 'Search result filters'. Now, you can drag and drop the filters according to your preference. The one on top will have the highest priority and the one on the bottom has the least. You can also disable certain results from your search results by turning off the toggleable button next to the name of the filter.

SMART LAUNCHER 5

Smart Launcher 5, the sequel app to the acclaimed Smart Launcher 3, is a balance of customisation and simplicity. The launcher is broken down into three simple elements – the app icons, widgets and Smart Search. The launcher is capable of automatically sorting your apps into several categories, and if you get the Pro version, you can



even add custom categories. Not only that, Smart Launcher 5 is also capable of the most precise widget placement since it does not use the grid to place widgets, allowing users free reign over placement and design language of their home screen. Here are some tips and tricks for this versatile yet simple launcher.



SMART UNIVERSAL SEARCH

The universal search on Smart Launcher 5 is extremely powerful and it can comb through several types of files to handpick the results that you're searching for, be it apps, contacts, web results, etc. Additionally, Smart Launcher 5 also pins your frequently-contacted people and apps at the top of the search page, which eliminates the need to have to search for these frequently-used apps or contact cards. Unfortunately though, the default web search on Smart Launcher 5 via the search bar is locked to Bing and to change it to another search engine, you will need to opt for the Pro version of the launcher.



USE GESTURES TO CONTROL YOUR DEVICE

Smart Launcher 5 comes equipped with built-in gestures and hotkeys support that helps you to link

a specific gesture to an action, app or shortcut of your choice. You can enable actions for simple swipe gestures such as swipe left, right, up and down as well as double tap. For instance, you can set a double tap to turn off your screen. The launcher also allows you to use a specific combo of gestures to activate a shortcut or action. A good amount of these gestures are pre-served for premium users.

To set up Gestures, go to Smart Launcher 5's Preferences window and then locate and tap on Gestures. Once you're in the Gestures window, tap on 'Enable gestures' and then tap on any of the gestures available to set corresponding actions. You can apply Smart Launcher specific actions such as show apps grid, show widgets, show status



Set up gestures to activate certain functions or open apps

bar, etc or even set other activities such as opening up a certain app.



HIDE STATUS AND NAVIGATION BARS

Smart Launcher 5 allows you to enter 'Immersive Mode' by hiding the status and navigation bars. This is a great feature to apply when you're consuming media or playing games, since it provides a more obstruction-free experience. This can be set up by configuring the mode to become active with a certain gesture or hotkey, or by turning it on via the global setting. To do this, go to Preferences in the Settings and then go to Global Appearance > Ultra immersive mode. Turn it on, and the status and navigation bars will disappear.



DOUBLE TAP TO OPEN DIFFERENT APP

In a similar vein to Nova Launcher's swipe actions for folders and actions, on Smart Launcher 5, you can open a different app when you double-tap the icon of a particular app on the home screen. For instance, on the Phone app, a single tap will open the Phone app itself, while a double-tap could be set up to open Truecaller or Contacts. To assign these secondary apps, long-press the icon of the app you want to assign the double-tap function to on the home screen, and then tap on the Settings icon in the window that pops up. Tap on the 'Double tap' button and then choose an app or even shortcut you'd like to set as the double-tap action. You can even set widgets as the double-tap action on the Pro version. 